

RICCARDO DI FRANCESCO

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(This version: *January 2026*)

CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Researcher

Oct. 2024–Present

Principal Investigator: *Seetha Menon*

University of Southern Denmark, Odense

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics and Finance

Sept. 2024

Advisor: *Franco Peracchi*

Co-advisor: *Tommaso Proietti*

Thesis: *“Three Essays in Causal Inference and Machine Learning”*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Master of Science in Economics

July 2020

Advisor: *Alberto Iozzi*

Thesis: *“Fleet Competition with Autonomous Vehicles: the Role of Ownership”*

Final Grade: 110/110 *summa cum laude*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Bachelor of Science in Political Economics

Oct. 2018

Advisor: *Francesco Nucci*

Thesis: *“Macroeconomic Impacts of Brexit”*

Final Grade: 107/110

University of Rome La Sapienza, Rome

RESEARCH VISITS

VinUniversity, Hanoi

Nov. 2025

Research visit to NLP Research Group

Host: *Mo El-Haj*

Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research, St. Gallen

Feb.–Dec. 2022

Visiting Ph.D. Student

Host: *Michael Lechner*

RESEARCH

Publications

- Di Francesco, R. (2026). [Aggregation Trees](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 1–26.
- Di Francesco, R., & Mellace, G. (2025). [Causal inference for qualitative outcomes](#). *Economics Letters*, 112626.
- Di Francesco, R. (2025). [Ordered Correlation Forest](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 44(4), 416–432.

Working Papers

- [The Cost of Coming Out](#) (joint with [Enzo Brox](#)). *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.03649*.

Software

- causalQual: Causal Inference for Qualitative Outcomes. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- valiCATE: Validation of CATE models. ([Website](#))
- ocf: Ordered Correlation Forest. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- aggTrees: Aggregation Trees. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))

REFeree ACTIVITIES

- Social Indicators Research

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Oct. 2023

Paper: *A further look at the gender gap in Italian academic careers*

Authors: Marianna Brunetti, Annalisa Fabretti, Mariangela Zoli

Research Assistant

July 2022

Paper: *Teaching an old dog a new trick: Reserve price and unverifiable quality in repeated procurement*

Authors: Gian Luigi Albano, Berardino Cesi, Alberto Iozzi

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference Reviewer

Jan. 2026

2026 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE)

University of the Basque Country, Bilbao

Conference Reviewer

Jan. 2025

2025 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE)

King's College London, London

Conference Co-organizer and Scientific Committee Member

Sept. 2024

1st Tor Vergata Ph.D. Conference in Economics

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

2026

- VIVE – Danish Center for Social Science Research (invited presentation).

2025

- 16th International Health Economics Association World Congress (IHEA).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- 38th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE).
- 11th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2024

- CSQIEP Virtual Seminar.
- Rome Conference on Econometrics: Frontiers in Casual Inference.
- 3rd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 29th International Panel Data Conference (IPDC).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Thessaloniki).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Xiamen).
- Annual Conference of the Scottish Economic Society (SES).

2023

- 2nd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 11th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).
- 10th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2022

- 1st Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 10th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Emerging Econometrician Award <i>Econometric Reviews</i> —Winner for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>Oct. 2025</i>
Student Best Paper Award <i>IAAE 2024 Thessaloniki</i> —Honorable mention for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>June 2024</i>
Ph.D. Scholarship <i>University of Rome Tor Vergata</i> —Scholarship fully financing Ph.D. studies.	<i>Oct. 2020</i>

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Guest Lecturer in Microeconometrics Master of Science course, taught by Giovanni Mellace University of Southern Denmark, Odense	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistics Bachelor of Science course, taught by Livia De Giovanni LUISS University, Rome	<i>Feb.–May 2024</i>
Teaching Assistant in Applied Statistics and Econometrics Bachelor of Science course, taught by Marianna Brunetti LUISS University, Rome	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2023</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistical Learning Master of Science course, taught by Tommaso Proietti University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome	<i>Sept.–Oct. 2021</i>

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Econometric Games—Team Captain Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2023</i>
Summer School in Causal Machine Learning Lecturer: Michael Lechner University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>Oct. 2022</i>
Summer School in Theoretical Aspects of Machine Learning Lecturer: Petyo Bonev University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>June 2022</i>
Summer School in Econometrics of Big Data Lecturers: Christian Hansen, Martin Spindler University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>June 2022</i>
Econometric Games—Team Captain Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2022</i>
Summer School in Semiparametric Learning Lecturer: Yanyuan Ma University of Trento, Trento	<i>July 2021</i>
Summer School in Microeconometrics and Machine Learning for Policy Evaluation Lecturers: David Margolis, Philipp Ketz, Margherita Comola Paris School of Economics, Paris	<i>June 2021</i>
Econometric Games—Team Member Selected as a member of the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2021</i>